



The benefits of flashing are manifold. If a new component has been added to the system, flashing the firmware allows it to recognize said component and enable its proper working. In the case of smart phones, various firmware updates are constantly being provided by the manufacturer to extend functionality, address bugs and whatnot. It's also been used by people who wish to switch carriers on their cellphones. However, say you could flash the firmware and add some features of your own? This opens up customization options beyond the typical updates. It also helps ensure people get the required updates for an OS.

One thing to be noted is that flashing the firmware of a device is not the same as jailbreaking or rooting it (or as Bill Shankly would've put it, "it is much more serious than that"). Jailbreaking simply allows one to remove any restrictions the original manufacturer placed on the device, such as locking parts of the OS. Flashing is the complete replacement of the firmware on the phone, whether by custom ROMs, or even stock firmware. It will not only add new features to the current architecture – if said features are beyond the capability of the available architecture, they won't have any effect. Despite their differences, flashing and jail-breaking still fall under the realm of hacks. Apple still thumbs its nose at the same, but they're thankfully not considered illegal anymore.

There's also a danger of bricking one's phone if the flashing is done incorrectly. A full battery is required for the complete process – a partial